

QuicknLabs

AI Agency Roadmap & Execution Plan

Complete Business Blueprint

Tax Strategy | AI Receptionist Service | AI Consulting & Audits

Lead Generation | Technical Stack | Pricing Packages

March 2026

QuicknLabs - AI Agency Roadmap & Execution Plan

Owner: You **Date Created:** March 8, 2026 **Goal:** \$10,000/month recurring revenue **Timeline:** Sprint start this week, scale over 90 days

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1. FINANCIAL SITUATION & TAX PLAN

Current Situation

- **Owed to IRS:** ~\$5,000 (prior year taxes)
- **Income:** Employed (receiving regular paychecks with tax withholding)

Action Plan

1. Set up an IRS Payment Plan immediately

2. Go to <https://www.irs.gov/payments/online-payment-agreement-application>
3. You can set up a Short-Term Payment Plan (180 days, no setup fee for online) if you can pay within 6 months
4. Or a Long-Term Installment Agreement (\$31 setup fee online) for monthly payments
5. Minimum monthly payment is roughly: $\text{balance} / 72 \text{ months}$, but you want to pay it faster
6. **Monthly allocation strategy:**
7. Your current job withholds taxes for THIS year - that's separate, don't touch it
8. From each paycheck, set aside an additional fixed amount (\$500-\$800/month) specifically for the IRS debt
9. Set up auto-pay through the IRS Direct Pay portal so you don't miss payments
10. **Important:** Do NOT use this year's withholdings to pay last year's debt. That will just create a new debt for this year. Keep them separate.
11. **Once QuicknLabs revenue starts:** Allocate 30% of all agency income to taxes (self-employment tax is ~15.3% + income tax)
12. **File quarterly estimated taxes** once agency income starts (Form 1040-ES) - due dates: April 15, June 15, September 15, January 15

Quick Wins

- Call IRS at 1-800-829-1040 or go online to set up the plan THIS WEEK
- Open a separate bank account or sub-account just for taxes
- Use a free tool like Wave (waveapps.com) to track agency income/expenses

2. BUSINESS OVERVIEW - QuicknLabs

What QuicknLabs Does

An AI automation agency that helps businesses replace or augment manual tasks (receptionists, virtual assistants, lead follow-up, appointment scheduling) with AI-powered solutions.

Two Core Service Lines

1. **AI Receptionist/VA Service** - Done-for-you AI phone agents + automation systems
2. **AI Consulting & Audits** - Paid audit + 90-day implementation plan + ongoing retainer

Target Revenue Breakdown (\$10K/month)

Source	Clients Needed	Price Point	Monthly Revenue
AI Receptionist packages	5 clients	\$1,000-\$1,500/mo	\$5,000-\$7,500

Source	Clients Needed	Price Point	Monthly Revenue
AI Audit + Implementation	1-2 clients	\$2,500-\$5,000	\$2,500-\$5,000
Total	6-7 clients		\$7,500-\$12,500

3. REVENUE STREAM #1: AI RECEPTIONIST / VIRTUAL ASSISTANT SERVICE

What You're Building

An AI phone agent that answers calls, books appointments, answers FAQs, routes calls, and integrates with the client's existing tools (Google Calendar, CRM, etc.)

Core Platform: Bland AI

- **Website:** <https://www.bland.ai>
- **What it does:** AI phone agents for inbound and outbound calls
- **API:** Yes - full REST API to create agents, make calls, manage phone numbers programmatically
- **Key features:**
 - Inbound call handling (receptionist)
 - Outbound calls (follow-ups, reminders, lead qualification)
 - Custom voices and personas
 - Call transfer to humans
 - Webhook integrations (trigger actions from calls)
 - Knowledge base upload (train on business-specific info)
- **Pricing:** Pay-per-minute model. Check <https://www.bland.ai/pricing> for current rates
- **API Docs:** <https://docs.bland.ai>

Alternatives to Bland AI (Compare Before Committing)

Platform	Strengths	API	Pricing Model
Bland AI	Simple API, good for agencies	Yes	Per-minute
Vapi (vapi.ai)	Developer-focused, very flexible	Yes	Per-minute
Retell AI (retellai.com)	Great voice quality, fast	Yes	Per-minute
Synthflow (synthflow.ai)	No-code, white-label ready	Yes	Monthly plans

Platform	Strengths	API	Pricing Model
Air AI (air.ai)	Fully autonomous agents	Limited	Enterprise

Recommendation: Start with **Vapi** or **Bland AI**. Both have great APIs. Vapi is more developer-friendly and may give you more control when building with Claude Code.

How to Build It (Technical Workflow)

1. **Client onboarding call** - Gather their business info, FAQs, hours, services
2. **Configure the AI agent** via Bland/Vapi API:
3. Upload knowledge base (business info, FAQs, pricing)
4. Set up call flows (greeting, routing, booking)
5. Configure voice and persona
6. **Connect integrations:**
7. Google Calendar API for appointment booking
8. Twilio or the platform's built-in phone numbers
9. Webhook to their CRM (or Google Sheets if they're simple)
10. Email notifications via SendGrid or similar
11. **Build a simple dashboard** (optional but impressive):
12. Call logs, transcripts, analytics
13. Next.js + Tailwind app hosted on Vercel
14. Pull data from Bland/Vapi API
15. **Test with the client** - Run test calls, refine the agent
16. **Go live** - Port their number or set up forwarding

What You Can Build with Claude Code

- The entire backend: API integrations, webhooks, automation scripts
 - Client dashboards (Next.js/React)
 - Onboarding forms that auto-configure agents
 - CRM integrations
 - Reporting/analytics scripts
-

4. REVENUE STREAM #2: AI CONSULTING & AUDITS

What an AI Audit Looks Like

Phase 1: Discovery Call (30-60 min) - FREE or \$97

Ask these questions: 1. What does your business do? Who are your customers? 2. How many employees do you have? What are their roles? 3. Walk me through a typical customer journey (from first contact to payment) 4. What are your biggest bottlenecks or pain points? 5. How do you currently handle: phone calls, emails, scheduling, follow-ups, data entry? 6. What software/tools do you currently use? (CRM, email, scheduling, etc.) 7. How much time per week does your team spend on repetitive tasks? 8. What's your current monthly cost for VAs, receptionists, or admin staff? 9. Have you tried any AI tools before? What was the experience? 10. What would it mean for your business if you could save 20+ hours per week?

Phase 2: Audit Report (Deliverable) - \$500-\$2,500

After the call, produce a professional document that includes: 1. **Executive Summary** - Key findings in 1 paragraph 2. **Current State Assessment** - Map of their current workflows 3. **Identified Opportunities** - Where AI can save time/money (ranked by impact) 4. **Recommended Solutions** - Specific tools and automations 5. **ROI Projection** - "You're spending \$X/month on Y, AI can reduce this to \$Z" 6. **90-Day Implementation Roadmap** - Phased plan with milestones 7. **Investment Required** - Your pricing for implementation

Phase 3: 90-Day Implementation - \$2,500-\$10,000

Month	Focus	Deliverables
Month 1	Foundation	Set up AI receptionist, basic automations, integrate with existing tools
Month 2	Optimization	Refine AI responses, add outbound follow-ups, build dashboard
Month 3	Scale	Add advanced workflows, train their team, handoff documentation

After 90 Days: Retainer - \$500-\$1,500/month

- Ongoing monitoring and optimization
- Monthly performance reports
- Bug fixes and updates
- Priority support

How People in the Industry Do It

Key figures to study: - **Liam Otley** (YouTube: Liam Otley) - Runs Morningside AI, built School community for AAA (AI Automation Agency) - His School community teaches the full agency

model - YouTube channel has free content on client acquisition, pricing, delivery - **Moritz Kremb** (YouTube) - AI agency content, technical tutorials - **Nick Saraev** (YouTube) - Automation-focused, Make.com / n8n workflows - **Brett Malinowski** (YouTube) - AI business models, monetization strategies

YouTube searches to do: - "AI automation agency audit process" - "how to sell AI to local businesses" - "AI receptionist agency setup" - "bland ai agency tutorial" - "vapi ai agency" - "90 day AI implementation plan template"

5. LEAD GENERATION & OUTREACH STRATEGY

Strategy A: LinkedIn Prospecting (Your "Low-Hanging Fruit")

How to Find Leads

1. **LinkedIn Search queries:**
2. "hiring receptionist remote"
3. "hiring virtual assistant remote"
4. "looking for receptionist"
5. "office manager hiring"
6. Filter by: Posted in last week, Companies with 10-50 employees
7. **LinkedIn Sales Navigator** (free trial available):
8. Filter by industry (medical, dental, legal, real estate)
9. Filter by company size (2-50 employees)
10. Filter by job postings mentioning "receptionist" or "virtual assistant"
11. **Job boards to monitor:**
12. Indeed, ZipRecruiter, Glassdoor - search "receptionist" + "remote"
13. These companies are actively spending money on this problem

LinkedIn Automation Tools

Tool	What It Does	Price
Phantombuster	Scrape LinkedIn profiles, auto-connect, auto-message	\$69/mo
Dripify	LinkedIn automation sequences	\$39/mo
Expandi	Smart LinkedIn outreach	\$99/mo
Apollo.io	Find emails + LinkedIn + outreach sequences	Free tier available
Instantly.ai	Cold email at scale	\$30/mo

Recommendation for tight budget: Start with **Apollo.io** (free tier: 10K leads/month) + manual LinkedIn outreach. Upgrade to Phantombuster or Instantly once you have revenue.

LinkedIn Outreach Message Template

```
Hi [Name],

I noticed you're looking for a [receptionist/VA] for [Company Name].

Quick question - have you considered an AI receptionist instead?

It answers calls 24/7, books appointments, and costs a fraction of a full-time hire. I recently set one up for a [similar business] and it handles 80%+ of their calls automatically.

Would you be open to a quick 10-min call to see if it might be a fit?

[Your Name]
QuicknLabs
```

Strategy B: Loom Video Outreach

Do Faceless Loom Videos Work?

- Videos WITH your face convert 2-3x better than faceless
- However, faceless screen recordings still work if the content is compelling
- **Best approach:** Screen recording showing their actual website + a quick demo of what the AI receptionist would sound like for their business

How to Create Personalized Loom Videos at Scale

1. Pull up their website
2. Paste their business info into Claude/ChatGPT: "Create a sample AI receptionist script for [business]"
3. Record a 60-90 second Loom showing:
4. Their website (so they know it's personalized)
5. The AI receptionist script you generated
6. A quick audio demo (use Bland/Vapi to generate a sample call)
7. Send via LinkedIn DM or email

Tools for Video Outreach

- **Loom** (free tier) - Screen recording
- **Sendspark** - Personalized video at scale

- **Vidyard** - Video for sales
- **Weezly** - Video + scheduling combined

Strategy C: AI Audit Outreach (Cold Email/LinkedIn)

Target: Businesses with 5-50 employees that are clearly not using AI

```
Subject: Quick question about [Company Name]'s workflow

Hi [Name],

I help [industry] businesses save 15-20 hours/week by identifying
where AI can handle repetitive tasks (phones, scheduling, follow-ups).

I recently helped a [similar business] cut their admin costs by 40%.

Would you be open to a free 15-minute AI opportunity assessment?
No pitch - just genuine insights you can use whether we work together or not.

[Your Name]
QuicknLabs
```

6. TECHNICAL STACK & HOSTING

Recommended Tech Stack

Layer	Tool	Why
Voice AI	Bland AI or Vapi	API-first, pay-per-use
Backend/Automations	Claude Code + Python/Node.js	You can build everything here
Client Dashboard	Next.js + Tailwind CSS	Modern, fast, easy to deploy
Hosting	Vercel (frontend) + Railway (backend)	Free tiers, easy deploy
Database	Supabase (free tier)	Postgres + Auth + API built-in
CRM	Google Sheets (start) or Airtable	Free, clients know it
Automation	n8n (self-hosted) or Make.com	Connect everything
Email	Resend or SendGrid	Transactional emails
Scheduling	Cal.com (open source)	Free, self-hostable
Phone Numbers	Twilio or platform-provided	Reliable, cheap

How to Host Client Dashboards

Option 1: Vercel (Recommended for starting out) - Free tier: unlimited projects, custom domains - Each client gets their own project/subdomain - Deploy from GitHub - push code, it's live - Example: `clientname.quicknlabs.com` (CNAME to Vercel)

Option 2: Railway - Great for backend services, APIs, databases - \$5/month hobby plan - Good for hosting n8n, APIs, cron jobs

Option 3: Render - Similar to Railway, generous free tier - Good for web services and background workers

Managing Multiple Clients

- **Use a monorepo with shared components** (one GitHub repo, different configs per client)
- Or use a **template repo** that you clone for each new client
- Environment variables per client (API keys, business info)
- Each client gets their own Supabase project (free tier per project)

Workflow with Claude Code

Claude Code is a CLI tool - you work in the terminal. Here's the workflow: 1. You describe what you want to build in conversation 2. Claude Code writes the code, creates files, runs commands 3. Code lives in your local files and GitHub repos 4. You deploy to Vercel/Railway from GitHub 5. To revisit a project: navigate to that repo folder and start a new Claude Code session

It's not a visual dashboard - it's a development tool. The dashboards you BUILD with it are what clients see.

7. WEEK 1 SPRINT PLAN (Get Your First Client)

Your Schedule Reality

- **Tuesday:** Busy (prayer 4AM, office, meetings) - minimal work
- **Friday:** Similar to Tuesday - minimal work
- **Mon, Wed, Thu, Sat, Sun:** Available - these are your execution days

Day-by-Day Plan

Monday (Day 1) - SETUP DAY

- [] Morning (2 hours):

- Set up IRS payment plan online
- Create QuicknLabs email (use Google Workspace \$6/mo or free Gmail)
- Set up LinkedIn profile for QuicknLabs positioning
- Update your personal LinkedIn headline: "I help businesses replace \$3K/month receptionists with AI that works 24/7"
- ☐ Afternoon/Evening (3 hours):
- Sign up for Bland AI or Vapi (free tier/trial)
- Build ONE demo AI receptionist (use a sample dental office or law firm)
- Record yourself calling it - save the recording
- Sign up for Apollo.io (free tier)

Tuesday (Day 2) - LIGHT DAY

- ☐ Evening only (1 hour):
- Use Apollo.io to find 20 businesses hiring receptionists
- Save them to a Google Sheet: Company, Contact, LinkedIn, Email, Industry

Wednesday (Day 3) - OUTREACH DAY

- ☐ Morning (2 hours):
- Send 10 personalized LinkedIn connection requests with the message template
- Send 10 cold emails using the audit outreach template
- ☐ Afternoon (2 hours):
- Record 3-5 personalized Loom videos for the highest-potential leads
- Each video: pull up their website, show what an AI receptionist could do for them
- ☐ Evening (1 hour):
- Post on LinkedIn about AI receptionists (educational content)
- Engage in comments on relevant posts

Thursday (Day 4) - FOLLOW-UP + BUILD

- ☐ Morning (1 hour):
- Follow up on any replies
- Send 10 more outreach messages
- ☐ Afternoon (3 hours):
- Build your AI audit template document (use the framework from Section 4)
- Create a simple one-page QuicknLabs website (use Carrd.co - \$19/year)
- Or build a quick landing page with Claude Code + deploy to Vercel

Friday (Day 5) - LIGHT DAY

- ☐ Evening only (1 hour):
- Check responses, reply to leads
- Refine your demo based on any feedback

Saturday (Day 6) - DEEP WORK

- ☐ Morning (3 hours):
- Follow up on all outreach from the week
- Send 20 more outreach messages
- Record more Loom videos
- ☐ Afternoon (3 hours):
- If you have an interested lead: prepare a custom demo for their business
- If no leads yet: post valuable content on LinkedIn, join Facebook groups for small business owners, engage in r/smallbusiness on Reddit

Sunday (Day 7) - REVIEW + PLAN

- ☐ Morning (2 hours):
- Review all metrics: messages sent, replies, calls booked
- Refine what's working
- Plan next week's outreach
- If you have a discovery call booked: prepare your audit questions

8. AUTOMATION PLAYBOOK

What Can Be Automated End-to-End

LEAD SCRAPING —> OUTREACH —> DEMO/CALL —> CLOSE —> DELIVERY
[Auto] [Semi] [Manual] [Manual] [Semi-Auto]

Level 1: What You Can Automate NOW

Task	Tool	How
Find leads hiring receptionists	Apollo.io API	Search filters, export to sheet
Enrich leads with emails	Apollo.io	Built-in email finder
Send cold emails at scale	Instantly.ai or Apollo	Email sequences with follow-ups

Task	Tool	How
LinkedIn connection requests	Manual (to stay safe)	Use templates, personalize
Schedule discovery calls	Cal.com or Calendly	Auto-scheduling link in emails
Client onboarding form	Google Forms or Typeform	Collect business info
Set up AI receptionist	Bland/Vapi API via script	Python script with client config

Level 2: What You Can Automate WITH CLAUDE CODE

- Build a script that takes a company URL, scrapes their info, and generates a custom AI receptionist config
- Auto-generate audit reports from discovery call notes
- Create client dashboards from a template with one command
- Auto-deploy client projects to Vercel

Level 3: Advanced Automation (After First Few Clients)

- Automated Loom-style videos using AI avatars (HeyGen, Synthesia)
- Outbound AI calls to leads using Bland AI
- Auto-qualify leads with an AI chatbot on your website
- Automated weekly reports to clients

Voice AI APIs for Automation

Platform	API Available	Use Case
Bland AI	Yes - REST API	Build/manage phone agents programmatically
Vapi	Yes - REST + WebSocket	Most developer-friendly, real-time control
Retell AI	Yes - REST API	High voice quality
ElevenLabs	Yes - REST API	Text-to-speech, voice cloning (not full phone agent)
PlayHT	Yes - REST API	Text-to-speech
Deepgram	Yes	Speech-to-text (transcription)

9. AVOIDING SCOPE CREEP

Rules for Every Client Engagement

1. **Define scope in writing BEFORE starting work**
2. Use a simple Statement of Work (SOW)
3. List exactly what's included and what's NOT included
4. Specify number of revision rounds (2-3 max)
5. **Simple SOW Template:** `` QuicknLabs - Statement of Work Client: [Name] Date: [Date]

INCLUDED: - AI receptionist setup (inbound calls only) - Integration with [Google Calendar / their CRM] - Up to [20] FAQ responses programmed - 2 rounds of revisions - 1 week of testing and refinement

NOT INCLUDED: - Outbound calling campaigns - Custom dashboard development - CRM migration - Marketing / lead generation - Changes after sign-off

Timeline: [2 weeks] Investment: \$[X] setup + \$[Y]/month

Additional work: \$150/hour ``

1. **When clients ask for extras:**
2. "Great idea! That would be a Phase 2 addition. I can scope that out for you separately."
3. Never say no - just say "yes, and here's what that costs"
4. **Use project milestones:**
5. Milestone 1: Setup complete - client reviews
6. Milestone 2: Integrations connected - client tests
7. Milestone 3: Go live - monitoring period
8. Each milestone needs client sign-off before moving forward

10. SCALING STRATEGY

Phase 1: Prove the Model (Month 1-2)

- Land 1-3 clients through manual outreach
- Deliver excellent results
- Document everything you build (for reuse)
- Get testimonials and case studies

Phase 2: Niche Down (Month 2-3)

Best niches for AI receptionist services (ranked by opportunity): 1. **Dental offices** - High call volume, appointment-heavy, often understaffed 2. **Medical practices** - Same as dental, higher willingness to pay 3. **Law firms** (small/solo) - Need professional call handling, hate missing leads 4. **Real estate agencies** - Lead follow-up is critical, lots of inbound inquiries 5. **Home services** (HVAC, plumbing, electrical) - Miss calls = miss jobs 6. **Med spas / beauty clinics** - Appointment-heavy, growing industry

Pick ONE. Build a perfect solution for that niche. Then copy-paste across similar businesses.

Phase 3: Productize (Month 3-6)

- Turn your custom builds into a repeatable product
- Create a self-service onboarding flow
- Standardize your packages (see Section 14)
- Hire a VA (\$5-10/hr from Philippines) to handle outreach while you focus on delivery

Phase 4: Scale (Month 6+)

- Build a team (freelancers for specific tasks)
- Create content (YouTube, LinkedIn) for inbound leads
- Consider white-labeling: let other agencies resell your tech
- Explore adjacent services (chatbots, email automation, lead gen)

11. GO HIGH LEVEL DOMAIN ISSUE - FIX

Your Problem

You had a Go High Level (GHL) sub-account through Liam Otley's School community. Your domain is pointed to that sub-account and you can't access it to disconnect.

How to Fix It

1. **Log into your domain registrar** (wherever you bought the domain - GoDaddy, Namecheap, Google Domains, Cloudflare, etc.)
2. **Go to DNS settings**
3. **Delete or change the DNS records** that point to Go High Level:
4. Look for A records or CNAME records pointing to GHL IPs/domains
5. GHL typically uses CNAME records pointing to something like `proxy.msgsndr.com` or similar

6. **Point your domain to your new site instead:**

7. If using Vercel: Add a CNAME record pointing to `cname.vercel-dns.com`

8. If using Carrd: Follow their custom domain instructions

9. **If you can't find the DNS records:** Contact your domain registrar's support - they can help you reset the DNS

You do NOT need access to the GHL sub-account to fix this. You just need access to where you bought the domain.

12. RESOURCES, REPOS, TOOLS & LINKS

YouTube Channels to Study

- **Liam Otley** - AI Automation Agency model, client acquisition
- **Nick Saraev** - Automation workflows (Make.com, n8n)
- **Brett Malinowski** - AI business models
- **Moritz Kremb** - Technical AI agency tutorials
- **Greg Isenberg** - Startup ideas, including AI businesses

Search These on YouTube

- "AI receptionist agency step by step"
- "bland ai tutorial"
- "vapi ai agency setup"
- "how to do an AI audit for businesses"
- "AI automation agency first client"
- "cold outreach LinkedIn AI agency"
- "n8n AI automation workflows"

GitHub Repos & Open Source Tools

- **n8n** (<https://github.com/n8n-io/n8n>) - Self-hosted automation platform (like Zapier but free)
- **Cal.com** (<https://github.com/calcom/cal.com>) - Open source scheduling (Calendly alternative)
- **Supabase** (<https://github.com/supabase/supabase>) - Open source Firebase alternative (database + auth)
- **Chatwoot** (<https://github.com/chatwoot/chatwoot>) - Open source customer support platform
- **Formbricks** (<https://github.com/formbricks/formbricks>) - Open source survey/form tool
- **Dub.co** (<https://github.com/dubinc/dub>) - Open source link management

- **Documenso** (<https://github.com/documenso/documenso>) - Open source DocuSign alternative (for contracts)

CRM Options for Your Agency

Tool	Cost	Best For
Google Sheets	Free	Starting out, tracking leads
Airtable	Free tier	More structured, relational data
HubSpot CRM	Free tier	Full CRM, overkill but powerful
Folk CRM	\$20/mo	Lightweight, great for agencies
Notion	Free	All-in-one workspace

Key Tools for QuicknLabs

Need	Tool	Link
Voice AI	Bland AI	https://bland.ai
Voice AI (alt)	Vapi	https://vapi.ai
Voice AI (alt)	Retell AI	https://retellai.com
Lead scraping	Apollo.io	https://apollo.io
Cold email	Instantly.ai	https://instantly.ai
Landing page (quick)	Carrd	https://carrd.co
Hosting	Vercel	https://vercel.com
Backend hosting	Railway	https://railway.app
Database	Supabase	https://supabase.com
Automation	n8n	https://n8n.io
Automation (no-code)	Make.com	https://make.com
Scheduling	Cal.com	https://cal.com
Video outreach	Loom	https://loom.com
Contracts	Documenso	https://documenso.com
Payments	Stripe	https://stripe.com
AI dev tool	Claude Code	You're already using it

Communities to Join (Free)

- r/artificial on Reddit
 - r/SaaS on Reddit
 - r/Entrepreneur on Reddit
 - r/smallbusiness on Reddit
 - Facebook groups: "AI Automation Agency", "AI for Business Owners"
 - Twitter/X: Follow #AIAgency, #AIAutomation hashtags
 - Discord: Search for AI automation communities
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13. WEEKLY SCHEDULE TEMPLATE

Based on your constraints (Tuesday/Friday busy, prayer flow Tuesday 4AM):

Day	Morning (6-9AM)	Daytime	Evening (7-10PM)
Monday	Outreach (emails, LinkedIn)	Job	Build/deliver client work
Tuesday	Prayer flow (4AM+)	Office + meetings	Rest or light admin
Wednesday	Outreach + follow-ups	Job	Deep work (building)
Thursday	Content creation (LinkedIn posts)	Job	Client calls / demos
Friday	Light admin	Similar to Tuesday	Rest or light work
Saturday	Deep work (building)	Outreach + follow-ups	Content / learning
Sunday	Weekly review + planning	Batch outreach prep	Rest

Weekly Targets

- Send 50+ outreach messages (LinkedIn + email combined)
 - Book 2-3 discovery calls
 - Create 2 LinkedIn posts (educational content about AI)
 - Record 5+ personalized Loom videos
 - Spend 4+ hours on delivery/building
-

14. PRICING & PACKAGES

Package 1: AI Receptionist - "Starter"

\$500 setup + \$497/month - AI phone receptionist (inbound calls) - Up to 500 minutes/month - Basic FAQ responses (up to 15 questions) - Google Calendar integration - Call transcripts & summaries - Email notifications for important calls - Business hours routing

Package 2: AI Receptionist - "Professional"

\$1,500 setup + \$997/month - Everything in Starter, plus: - Up to 2,000 minutes/month - Advanced call routing - CRM integration - Appointment booking with confirmation - Follow-up text messages - Custom voice & persona - Monthly performance report - Outbound appointment reminders

Package 3: Full AI Automation Suite - "Enterprise"

\$3,000 setup + \$1,997/month - Everything in Professional, plus: - Outbound lead follow-up calls - Email automation sequences - Client dashboard with analytics - Multi-channel (phone + chat + email) - Priority support - Quarterly optimization reviews

AI Audit Pricing

- **Discovery Call:** Free (15-30 min)
- **Full AI Audit Report:** \$997 one-time
- **Audit + 90-Day Implementation:** \$4,997-\$9,997
- **Ongoing Retainer (post-implementation):** \$497-\$1,497/month

15. PATH TO \$10K/MONTH

Month 1: Foundation (\$0 - \$2,000)

- [] Get 1 AI receptionist client (\$997/mo)
- [] Do 1 paid AI audit (\$997 one-time)
- [] Build your portfolio/case study from these
- **Revenue: ~\$2,000**

Month 2: Momentum (\$2,000 - \$5,000)

- [] Get 2 more receptionist clients (\$2,000/mo recurring)
- [] Do 1 more audit + start implementation (\$2,500)

- [] First client referral
- **Revenue: ~\$4,500**

Month 3: Scale (\$5,000 - \$10,000)

- [] 5 total receptionist clients (\$5,000/mo recurring)
- [] 1 implementation project (\$3,000-5,000)
- [] Start content marketing (LinkedIn, YouTube)
- [] Inbound leads starting to come in
- **Revenue: ~\$8,000-\$10,000**

Key Metrics to Track

- Outreach messages sent per week
- Response rate
- Discovery calls booked
- Close rate
- Monthly recurring revenue (MRR)
- Client churn rate
- Average revenue per client

QUICK REFERENCE: YOUR IMMEDIATE NEXT STEPS

1. **TODAY:** Set up IRS payment plan
2. **TODAY:** Sign up for Bland AI or Vapi (free tier)
3. **TODAY:** Sign up for Apollo.io (free tier)
4. **TODAY:** Update your LinkedIn headline
5. **TOMORROW:** Build your first demo AI receptionist
6. **THIS WEEK:** Send 50 outreach messages
7. **THIS WEEK:** Book your first discovery call
8. **THIS WEEK:** Create a simple landing page (Carrrd.co or Vercel)

LinkedIn Automation & Outreach Research for AI Agencies

Date: March 8, 2026

1. Finding Companies Hiring Receptionists/Virtual Assistants on LinkedIn

LinkedIn Search Strategies

Direct Job Search Keywords: - "virtual receptionist," "virtual assistant," "remote receptionist," "front desk" - Filter by Remote work type, Entry Level / Associate experience

LinkedIn Sales Navigator (Advanced): - Boolean Search: Craft strings like "receptionist" OR "front desk" OR "virtual assistant" to find companies actively posting these roles - **Account Filters:** Target industries with high front-desk needs: healthcare, legal, dental, hospitality, real estate - **Company Size:** Focus on SMBs (10-200 employees) -- these feel receptionist costs the most and are prime AI replacement candidates - **Job Posting Signals:** Companies actively posting receptionist/front desk openings have immediate need - **Buyer Intent Signals:** AI-powered filter that surfaces leads showing buying patterns based on platform behavior (available on Advanced/Advanced Plus plans) - **Technologies Used Filter:** Find companies using competitor products you want to replace - **Spotlight Filters:** Behavioral/activity-based filters that reveal leads most likely to reply

Practical Targeting for AI Receptionist Sales: 1. Search for companies posting receptionist job openings (these have budget + immediate need) 2. Target industries: medical/dental offices, law firms, real estate agencies, salons/spas, hospitality 3. Filter to decision-makers: Office Manager, Operations Manager, Practice Manager, Owner 4. Use keyword filters on company Overview/Specialties fields 5. Stack filters to narrow from thousands to the exact 1-5% worth contacting

Key Companies Already in the VA/Receptionist Space: - Smith.ai, BELAY, MyOutDesk, Wishup, MedVA

Market Context: - 49,000+ VA jobs on LinkedIn currently - VA industry projected at \$19.5B in 2025, growing to \$55.4B by 2035 (CAGR 11%) - Virtual receptionist pricing: \$29/month (AI tools) to \$5,000/month (premium human services) -- your AI product fits right in this gap

2. LinkedIn Automation Tools (Legal Ones)

Tool Comparison

Tool	Type	Pricing	Safety Level	Best For
PhantomBuster	Cloud-based	\$69-\$439/mo	Medium	Data extraction, multi-platform automation
Expandi	Cloud-based	~\$99/mo	High	Safe LinkedIn automation, smart limits
SalesRobot	Cloud-based	~\$99/mo	High	Compliance-focused outreach
Dux-Soup	Browser extension	\$14.99-\$55/mo	Medium	Budget LinkedIn automation
HeyReach	Cloud-based	~\$79/mo	High	Team-based LinkedIn outreach
Skylead	Cloud-based	~\$100/mo	High	Multi-channel (LinkedIn + email)
LinkedIn Sales Navigator	Official LinkedIn	\$99-\$179/mo	Highest	Prospecting/search (no automation built in)

PhantomBuster Details

- **Features:** Network Booster (auto-connect), Data Enrichment, Message Sender, Sales Navigator Export
- **Pricing:** Starter \$69/mo (20hrs), Pro \$159/mo (80hrs), Team \$439/mo (300hrs)
- **Risk:** Some users reported bans with aggressive use
- **Integration:** Works with Sales Navigator -- use Search Export with Watcher mode, chain to LinkedIn Outreach Phantom

Safety Best Practices

- Stay within **50-100 connection requests/day**
- Limit profile views to ~500/day (standard) or 1,000-2,000/day (Sales Navigator)
- Use cloud-based tools (safer than browser extensions)
- Always personalize messages
- Warm up new accounts gradually
- Use activity limits and warm-up protocols

Recommended Stack

- **Apollo.io** for prospecting + enrichment + email outreach

- **Expandi or SalesRobot** for LinkedIn automation
 - **Sales Navigator** for search/targeting
-

3. Cold Outreach Best Practices for AI Services

Key Strategies

- 1. Warm Up Before Pitching** - Engage with prospects' content before sending messages - View profiles, like posts, comment on their content - This dramatically improves acceptance and reply rates
- 2. Lead with Relevance, Not Features** - Distill your AI service into 2-3 simple outcomes - Translate each into a benefit that matters to the prospect - Example: "We help dental offices save \$3,000/month by replacing their front desk phone system with AI" (not "We have an AI receptionist with NLP capabilities")
- 3. Use Trigger-Based Outreach** - Target when decision-makers change roles (3x reply rates) - New funding rounds, executive hires, tech stack changes - Companies posting receptionist job openings = immediate trigger
- 4. Multi-Channel Approach** - LinkedIn + Email combined outreach - 90% of outbound goes to email; LinkedIn is underutilized -- this is an opportunity - Supplement with regular content posts to build trust
- 5. Balance Automation with Human Touch** - Don't over-automate -- prospects can tell - Use AI for research and initial personalization, but add genuine human elements
- 6. Protect Your Domain** - Set up separate domain for cold email - Configure SPF, DKIM, DMARC - Warm up mailbox for 2-4 weeks before scaling

Benchmarks

- **Connection Rate:** Aim for 30-50% accepted
- **Reply Rate:** Good = 10%+, Great = 20-25%
- **Cold Email Reply Rate:** Average is only 1-5% (video outreach can 10x this)
- **Conversion Rate:** Track % of responses that become meetings

Cost Estimates (per 1,000-contact campaign)

- Contact search (Sales Navigator + Apollo): ~\$500-800
- Message personalization (in-house): ~33 hours at \$25/hr = ~\$825
- Total: ~\$1,300-1,600 per 1,000 contacts (in-house)

4. Loom Video Outreach -- Faceless vs. Face-on-Camera

Does Video Outreach Work?

Absolutely yes. The data is overwhelming: - Qwilr: Conversions jumped from 28.6% to 57% with Loom videos - Intercom: Cold email reply rates +19%, \$120K in outbound deals - SalesLoft: +16% open rates, +26% replies, 4x click-through - Forrester: 300% increase in click-through rate with video in email - Zendesk: 41.6% response rate with video vs. 1.3% with text

Do Faceless Loom Videos Work?

Mixed answer: - Face on camera is generally recommended -- it builds trust and personal connection, which drives the highest conversion lifts - **Faceless (screen-only) CAN work** for: - Product demos and walkthroughs - Showing the prospect's website/problems - "Trojan Horse" strategy: lead with real value (audit their site, show missed calls data) - Screen recordings with voice narration - **No published data** directly comparing faceless vs. face conversion rates - **Recommendation:** If camera-shy, use Loom's avatar mode or Sendspark's AI approach (record once, AI personalizes)

The "Trojan Horse" Loom Strategy (Best for AI Agencies)

1. Record a screen share of the prospect's website
2. Call their business phone and show the experience (long hold times, missed calls)
3. Demo what your AI receptionist sounds like handling the same call
4. Don't pitch -- just offer value and insights
5. End with a soft CTA: "Happy to show you more if interested"

Loom Capture Modes

- Screen and Camera (recommended for trust)
 - Screen Only (faceless)
 - Camera Only
 - Avatar mode (personal touch without full face)
-

5. Automating Personalized Loom-Style Videos

Top Tools

Sendspark (Best for AI-Personalized Video at Scale)

- **How it works:** Record ONE base video, AI generates thousands of personalized versions
- **Key features:** Voice cloning, dynamic backgrounds (scrolls prospect's website/LinkedIn), AI personalization
- **Pricing:** Solo \$39/mo, Growth \$69/mo, Team \$199/mo, Business \$499/mo
- **Results:** 200-300% increase in email response rates, 40-50% jump in booked meetings
- **Case study:** Warmly generated \$100K ARR in one month re-engaging closed-lost opportunities
- **Time savings:** Reps save 10+ hours by recording just one base video

Vidyard (Enterprise-Grade)

- **How it works:** AI Avatars create digital versions of reps; Video Agent auto-generates videos based on prospect actions
- **Key features:** Deep HubSpot/Salesforce integration, video analytics, AI Avatars
- **Pricing:** Starts at \$59+/user/mo, business plans \$300+/mo
- **Results:** 28% increased pipeline, 27% shorter deal cycles

Other Notable Tools

Tool	Best For	Key Feature
Pitchlane	SDR teams	AI personalized video at scale
HeyGen	AI avatar videos	Realistic AI-generated presenter videos
Dubb	Video sequences	Automated video drip campaigns + LinkedIn integration
Synthesia	Faceless AI video	AI avatars, no camera needed at all

Recommendation for AI Agency

Sendspark is the best fit because: 1. Record one demo of your AI receptionist 2. AI personalizes it for each prospect (shows their website, uses their name via voice cloning) 3. \$39/mo starting price is very affordable 4. Integrates with outreach tools 5. Solves the "faceless" problem -- you record once with face, AI handles the rest

6. Apollo.io for Lead Generation

Pricing (2026)

Plan	Monthly (Annual)	Monthly (Monthly)	Credits/ Mo	Key Features
Free	\$0	\$0	Limited	Basic search, limited emails
Basic	\$49/user	\$59/user	More credits	Sequences, integrations
Professional	\$79/user	\$99/user	Even more	Unlimited sequences, A/B testing, AI insights, lead scoring
Organization	\$119/user (min 3)	\$149/user (min 3)	Most	Advanced API, custom reports, international dialer

Credit System (Important!)

- 1 credit = 1 business email found
- 8 credits = 1 mobile phone number
- Credits expire each billing cycle
- Overage: \$0.20/credit (250 minimum purchase)
- **Real cost is often 2-3x advertised price** due to credit consumption

Key Features

- **AI Research:** Auto-generates personalized talking points per lead from LinkedIn, company news, web presence
- **AI Lead Scoring:** Predicts which leads will convert based on engagement signals
- **Meeting Intelligence:** Call recording, AI summaries, auto follow-up tasks
- **Data enrichment** across 275M+ contacts
- **Sequences** with email, calls, and tasks
- **Integrations:** Salesforce, HubSpot, Outreach, SalesLoft, LinkedIn

API Access

- **Basic/Professional:** Very limited API access
- **Organization (\$119+/user/mo, min 3 users):** Full Advanced API access
- Needed for: pushing data to custom tools, CRM integrations, custom workflows
- This is a significant cost barrier -- \$357/mo minimum for API access

Best Use for AI Agency

1. Use Apollo to build lists of companies in target industries (dental, legal, medical)
 2. Filter by company size (10-200 employees), location, industry
 3. Find decision-maker contacts (Office Manager, Owner, Practice Manager)
 4. Enrich with emails and phone numbers
 5. Export to your outreach sequences
 6. Use AI Research feature to personalize messaging
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7. Open-Source CRMs for AI Agencies

Top Picks

Twenty CRM (Best Modern Option)

- **GitHub:** Most starred modern open-source CRM
- **Stack:** Modern web stack, self-hostable
- **AI:** MCP Server integration -- works with Claude for natural language CRM management
- **Best for:** Teams wanting a Salesforce alternative with full data control

Frappe CRM

- **GitHub:** `frappe/crm`
- **Stack:** Built on Frappe Framework (Python)
- **Features:** All-in-one lead/deal page, extensible, part of ERPNext ecosystem
- **Best for:** Teams already using or considering ERPNext

AI CRM Agents

- **GitHub:** `KlementMultiverse/ai-crm-agents`
- **Features:** 6 autonomous AI agents for lead qualification, email intelligence, sales pipeline, customer success, meeting scheduling, analytics
- **Best for:** AI-native agencies wanting agent-driven CRM

Krayin CRM

- **GitHub:** `krayin/laravel-crm`
- **Stack:** Laravel + Vue.js
- **Features:** Complete customer lifecycle, WhatsApp extension for lead gen
- **Best for:** PHP/Laravel teams

EspoCRM

- **GitHub:** `espocrm/espocrm`
- **Features:** Leads, contacts, opportunities, campaigns, highly customizable
- **Best for:** Traditional CRM needs with self-hosting

Iceburg CRM

- **GitHub:** `iceburgcrm/iceburgcrm`
- **Features:** Metadata-driven, 29 themes, AI-powered CRM creation (describe what you want, AI builds it)
- **Best for:** Rapid custom CRM setup

Recommendation for AI Agency

Twenty CRM + **n8n** (for automation) is the most modern, capable stack. If you want AI agents built in, look at `ai-crm-agents` .

8. GoHighLevel Alternatives (Cheaper / Self-Hostable)

GHL Pricing Context

- Starter: \$97/mo
- Unlimited: \$297/mo
- SaaS Pro: \$497/mo

Self-Hosted Open Source Stack (Best Value)

Build your own "GHL" with these open-source tools:

Component	Tool	Replaces
Marketing Automation	Mautic (free, self-hosted)	GHL email/SMS campaigns, workflows, landing pages
CRM	Twenty or EspoCRM (free, self-hosted)	GHL CRM, pipeline management
Workflow Automation	n8n (free, self-hosted)	GHL automations, Zapier integration
Live Chat / Messaging	Chatwoot (free, self-hosted)	GHL chat widget, WhatsApp, social DMs
	Mautic or WordPress	GHL funnels and forms

Component	Tool	Replaces
Forms / Landing Pages		
Appointment Scheduling	Cal.com (open source)	GHL calendar booking

Total cost: \$0-50/mo (just server hosting) vs. \$97-497/mo for GHL

SaaS Alternatives (Cheaper than GHL)

Tool	Starting Price	Best For
Systeme.io	Free plan available	Solo entrepreneurs, basic funnels
ActiveCampaign	\$29/mo	Email automation, CRM lite
Kartra	\$99/mo	Course creators, digital marketing
ClickFunnels	\$97/mo	Sales funnels specifically
ToolJet	Free (self-hosted)	Custom internal tools, CRM building
Vendasta	Custom pricing	Agency white-label platform

Recommended Self-Hosted Stack for AI Agency

```
Mautic (marketing automation)
+ Twenty CRM (customer management)
+ n8n (workflow automation / integrations)
+ Chatwoot (live chat / omnichannel messaging)
+ Cal.com (appointment scheduling)
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All free, all self-hostable, all have APIs for integration. Use n8n as the glue to connect everything.

Summary: Recommended Tech Stack for AI Agency Outreach

Lead Generation

1. **Apollo.io** (Professional plan, \$79/mo) -- build prospect lists, enrich contacts
2. **LinkedIn Sales Navigator** (\$99/mo) -- advanced search, buyer intent signals

LinkedIn Automation

1. **Expandi** or **SalesRobot** (~\$99/mo) -- safe cloud-based LinkedIn outreach

Video Outreach

1. **Sendspark** (\$39/mo) -- record once, AI personalizes thousands of videos

CRM

1. **Twenty CRM** (free, self-hosted) -- or Apollo's built-in CRM for simplicity

Marketing Automation

1. **Mautic** (free, self-hosted) -- email sequences, landing pages, lead nurturing

Workflow Automation

1. **n8n** (free, self-hosted) -- connect everything together

Total Monthly Cost: ~\$316/mo

(vs. \$500-1,000+/mo for equivalent SaaS stack)

Sources

- [Dux-Soup: Best LinkedIn Automation Tools 2026](#)
- [Reply.io: Top 20+ LinkedIn Automation Tools 2026](#)
- [PhantomBuster: LinkedIn Automation Warning](#)
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- [SalesCaptain: Cold LinkedIn Outreach 2025](#)
- [Expandi: State of LinkedIn Outreach H1 2025](#)
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AI Automation Agency Research

Comprehensive Guide to AI Audits, Implementation & Business Building

Research compiled: March 2026

1. AI Audit Questions Consultants Ask During Discovery

Phase 1: Understanding the Business

- What are your top 3-5 most time-consuming repetitive processes?
- Where does your team spend the most time on manual data entry or transfer?
- What tools/software does your team use daily? (CRM, email, project management, etc.)
- What does your current tech stack look like? Do your tools integrate with each other?
- How many hours per week does your team spend on tasks that follow a repeatable template or set of rules?
- What is your average customer value / close rate / monthly lead volume?

Phase 2: Pain Point Identification

- Where are the biggest bottlenecks in your customer journey?
- What tasks does your team complain about most?
- How do you currently handle customer support inquiries? What percentage are repetitive/similar?

- What does your onboarding process look like (for clients or employees)?
- How do you generate and follow up with leads?
- What data do you collect but never analyze or act on?

Phase 3: Technical Readiness Assessment

- Do your current systems have APIs available for integration?
- How is your data structured? (databases, spreadsheets, scattered documents)
- What security/compliance requirements exist in your industry?
- Do you have documented SOPs (Standard Operating Procedures) for key workflows?
- Who owns the code/IP if custom solutions are built?

Phase 4: ROI & Value Assessment

- What is the fully loaded cost (salary + overhead) of employees doing these manual tasks?
- If you could free up 10-20 hours per week of staff time, where would you redeploy that?
- What would a 20-30% improvement in response time / lead conversion be worth?
- Have you tried any AI tools or automation before? What worked or failed?

ROI Prioritization Matrix (Use During Audit)

Category	Action
High ROI / Low Complexity	Quick wins -- automate first (e.g., document classification, data entry)
High ROI / High Complexity	Strategic bets -- plan carefully (e.g., recommendation engines)
Low ROI / Low Complexity	Automate only if it unlocks staff time for bigger wins
Low ROI / High Complexity	Drop or redesign the process entirely

ROI Formula: Annual ROI = (Hours Saved x Fully Loaded Cost) + (Revenue Uplift) - (AI Platform + Maintenance Costs)

2. Typical 90-Day AI Implementation Plan

Phase 1: Assessment & Alignment (Days 1-30)

- **Week 1-2:** Conduct full workflow audit across People, Process, and Platforms
- **Week 2-3:** Map current-state SOPs, handoffs, and systems
- **Week 3-4:** Score and prioritize automation opportunities using the "Golden Triangle" framework (High Pain, Low Complexity, Clear ROI)

- Build cross-functional team: AI developer, business analyst, executive sponsor
- Provide basic AI literacy training for stakeholders
- Select 1-2 pilot projects to prove value
- Define success metrics (accuracy, time saved, revenue impact, NPS)

Phase 2: Pilot Execution (Days 31-60)

- Build and deploy the selected pilot project(s)
- Integrate with existing tools and systems
- Conduct testing cycles (accuracy, consistency, speed)
- Gather user feedback and iterate
- Document everything for future scaling
- Begin measuring KPIs against baselines

Phase 3: Scale & Governance (Days 61-90)

- Analyze pilot results and present ROI to stakeholders
- Develop scaling plan for successful automations
- Establish AI governance framework (ownership, accountability, monitoring)
- Create standard operating procedures for AI systems
- Plan next wave of automation opportunities
- Set up ongoing monitoring and optimization processes
- Transition to retainer/support engagement

Key Success Factors

- Allocate at least **20% of budget to training and change management**
- Start with the least risky automations first (e.g., metadata, data entry before full decision-making)
- 64% of CEOs say successful AI adoption depends more on people than technology
- 30% of generative AI projects fail past proof of concept due to poor data quality (Gartner)

3. Top People in the AI Automation Agency Space

Liam Ottley

- **Role:** Creator of the AI Automation Agency (AAA) model; Founder & CEO of Morningside AI
- **YouTube:** 713K+ subscribers (started Jan 2023)

- **Community:** AAA Accelerator -- 3,800+ students; Skool community (AI Automation Agency Hub, 140K+ members)
- **Background:** Born in New Zealand, based in Dubai. Self-described 8-figure AI entrepreneur
- **Course:** AAA Accelerator (~\$1,500-\$5,200 depending on region/sales); 8 modules, 60+ hours
- **Notable:** Published a 6-month AI Automation Agency Roadmap
- **Website:** liamottley.com / aaaaccelerator.com

Moritz Kremb

- **Role:** Founder of Prompt Warrior newsletter; AI educator and content creator
- **Background:** 7+ years in consulting and product management; previously connected to Vimcar
- **Community:** Associated with AI Automation Agency Hub on Skool (140K+ members)
- **Products:** AI Growth Kit, "The Prompt Champion" prompt optimizer
- **Focus:** Teaching people to leverage AI for business growth; built a SaaS making \$20K/month
- **Website:** moritzkremb.com / thepromptwarrior.com

Nick Saraev

- **Role:** Certified Make.com expert; runs LeftClick AI (performance optimization agency)
- **YouTube:** ~181K subscribers
- **Focus:** n8n and Make.com tutorials; practical automation builds
- **Community:** Skool community helping people reach \$25K/mo with automation
- **Notable:** Featured creator on n8n's platform; known for deep technical tutorials
- **Website:** nicksaraev.com / leftclick.ai

Brett Malinowski

- **Role:** Futurist, AI agency owner (WGMI Labs)
- **Focus:** AI + no-code SaaS; makes ~\$30K/month from AI automation
- **Content:** "We're Gonna Make It" podcast (Spotify/Apple); WGMI Media newsletter
- **Website:** wgmilabs.com

Liam Evans

- Described as "the father of the AI Automation Agency (AIAA) model"
- Provides foundational insights into AI agency business building

Other Notable Figures

- **Charlie Barber** -- Entrepreneurial AI content
 - **Webcafe AI** -- Business AI/ChatGPT integration tutorials
-

4. Frameworks & Templates for AI Business Audits

Established Enterprise Frameworks

1. **NIST AI Risk Management Framework** -- US standard for AI transparency, safety, and accountability
2. **IIA AI Auditing Framework** -- Published by the Institute of Internal Auditors; dedicated AI audit methodology
3. **COBIT (ISACA)** -- Internal controls, risk metrics, and performance measures for IT/AI governance
4. **COSO Enterprise Risk Management** -- Governance, strategy, and stakeholder collaboration for AI risk
5. **ISO 42001** -- International standard for AI management systems
6. **EU AI Act** -- Global regulatory standard (especially for "high-risk" AI systems)
7. **Colorado AI Act (SB 205)** -- First comprehensive US state framework (effective 2026)

Consulting Firm Approaches

- **Deloitte's 4-Step AI Governance:** (1) Validate AI landscape/inventory, (2) Assess governance vs. leading practices, (3) Identify missing guardrails, (4) Test control design and effectiveness
- **EY's Internal Audit:** Structured risk assessment frameworks, inventory mapping, KPI definition, post-assessment workshops
- **PwC:** Expects end-to-end AI audit automation within 2026

Practical Agency-Level Templates

- **3-Zone Diagnostic:** People, Process, Platforms -- examine how the team works with digital tools, bottlenecks, and system readiness
- **Workflow Scoring Matrix:** Audit 3-5 workflows, document SOPs, handoffs, and systems, define success metrics
- **Auditic Platform:** AI-powered discovery interviews, opportunity matrix (impact-effort scoring), ROI calculators with industry benchmarks, proposal generators
- **Process Street:** Free customizable audit templates for compliance, vendor management, operational reviews

- **monitorQA:** AI-powered audit template builder with auto-filling, conditional logic, multilingual checklists

The "Audit as Sales Tool" Framework

- Charge \$500-\$1,500 for a standalone audit as a paid deliverable
- Some charge \$5,000-\$15,000 for a comprehensive 2-4 week "AI Readiness Audit"
- The audit naturally leads to \$2,000-\$50,000+ implementation engagements
- "Once you've done the diagnosis, you become the obvious person to build the solution"

5. Pricing Models for AI Consulting/Implementation

Paid Discovery / Audit Phase

Service	Price Range
Quick audit (standalone)	\$500 -- \$1,500
AI Readiness Audit (2-4 weeks)	\$5,000 -- \$15,000

Project-Based (One-Time Fees)

Project Size	Price Range
Small pilot / MVP	\$5,000 -- \$40,000
Medium (custom ML model + integration)	\$40,000 -- \$150,000
Enterprise AI transformation	\$100,000 -- \$500,000
Custom build setup fees	\$2,500 -- \$15,000+

Monthly Retainers

Tier	Price Range
Basic AI management & support	\$2,000 -- \$5,000/mo
Growth-focused (optimization + new builds)	\$5,000 -- \$15,000/mo
AI system support retainer	\$2,000 -- \$8,000/mo
Enterprise multi-agent management	Up to \$20,000+/mo

Consulting / Hourly Rates

Type	Rate
Independent consultant (hourly)	\$100 -- \$450/hr
Freelancer (daily)	\$600 -- \$1,200/day
Agency (daily, multi-disciplinary)	\$1,500 -- \$2,500/day

Performance-Based Pricing

- 20-30% of first-year documented savings
- Fee per qualified lead generated
- Percentage of revenue increase attributable to AI

Hybrid Model (Recommended Approach)

1. Start with project-based pricing for initial traction (quick cash injection)
2. Transition clients to retainer model once value is proven (predictable recurring revenue)
3. Add usage-based fees tied to token consumption / API calls for scaling

Key Principles

- Price based on VALUE created, not hours spent
- Focus on business impact: time saved, costs reduced, revenue increased
- The technology stack affects pricing: Make.com/Zapier solutions cost less than custom code
- Data preparation alone can cost \$10K-\$90K depending on complexity

6. Best Industries to Target for AI Automation

Tier 1: Highest ROI / Proven Demand

1. **Healthcare & Medical** -- Patient onboarding, compliance, medical imaging, scheduling.
Market projected at \$28.5B+
2. **Financial Services & Banking** -- Fraud detection, KYC, risk management, compliance automation
3. **E-commerce & Retail** -- Inventory AI, recommendation engines, customer care automation
4. **SaaS Companies (High-Touch)** -- Sales automation, onboarding, managed services.
Companies with \$1M-\$100M revenue
5. **Digital Marketing / Lead Gen Agencies** -- 80%+ of companies use AI for marketing; post scheduling, ad placement, content creation

Tier 2: High Growth / Less Saturated

1. **Manufacturing & Supply Chain** -- 81% of manufacturers say AI is critical; predictive maintenance, quality control, inventory
2. **Legal & Professional Services** -- Document automation, compliance, contract review, smart CRMs
3. **Real Estate** -- Lead qualification, property matching, document processing
4. **Insurance** -- Claim triage, policy validation, customer communication automation

Tier 3: Emerging / Underserved Niches

1. **Med Spas** -- \$1.4-2M avg annual revenue per location, \$6K+ customer LTV, desperate for modern marketing
2. **Cybersecurity** -- AI-powered security market projected at \$14.9B by 2025
3. **BPO / Outsourcing** -- Reducing manual workload across support, data entry, ticket handling
4. **AI Content Repurposing** -- Turning long-form content into platform-specific assets

Ideal Target Profile

- Businesses already spending money (revenue \$500K+)
- Industries with 20-35% annual AI spend increases
- Acute pain points: labor shortages, compliance burdens, slow response times
- Digital B2B niches (easier lead sourcing than brick-and-mortar)
- Mid-market companies (\$5M-\$100M) -- big enough to afford, small enough to lack in-house AI teams

7. YouTube Channels, Courses & Resources

YouTube Channels (AI Automation Agency Focused)

Channel	Subscribers	Focus
Liam Ottley	713K+	AAA model, business building, scaling
Nick Saraev	181K+	Make.com, n8n, technical automation tutorials
Brett Malinowski	Large following	AI + no-code SaaS, futurism
Webcafe AI	Growing	OpenAI/ChatGPT business integration
Liam Evans	Growing	AIAA model foundations
Charlie Barber	Growing	Entrepreneurial AI content

Paid Courses

Course	Creator	Price	Notes
AAA Accelerator	Liam Ottley	~\$1,500-\$5,200	8 modules, 60+ hrs, 6-month mentorship. Most comprehensive but high-pressure sales
Skool Communities	Various	Free-\$99/mo	AI Automation Agency Hub (140K members), Nick Saraev's community
Udemy Courses	Various	\$10-\$100	YouTube automation, n8n basics, Make.com tutorials

Free Resources

- **AI Automation Agency Hub** (Skool) -- 140K+ members, free content from Liam Ottley
- **n8n Community Workflows** -- 5,815+ AI automation workflow templates
- **Nick Saraev's YouTube** -- Deep technical Make.com and n8n tutorials
- **WGMI Media Newsletter** -- Brett Malinowski's free weekly AI newsletter
- **Prompt Warrior Newsletter** -- Moritz Kremb's AI guides

Frameworks & Templates (Free/Low-Cost)

- **Liam Ottley's 6-Month AAA Roadmap** (Scribd)
- **Process Street** -- Free audit templates
- **Auditic** -- AI discovery and consulting platform
- **Framer AI Agency Website Templates** -- workflow.framer.website

Key Communities

- **Skool** -- Primary platform for AI agency communities
- **Reddit** -- r/artificial, r/automation, r/entrepreneur (search "AI agency")
- **BlackHatWorld** -- AI automation agency business discussions

8. Tools AI Agencies Commonly Use

Core Automation Platforms

Tool	Purpose	Best For
Make.com	Visual workflow automation	Primary agency tool; drag-and-drop, scalable
n8n	Open-source workflow automation	Self-hosted solutions, developer-friendly. Valued at \$2.3B (Aug 2025)

Tool	Purpose	Best For
Zapier	Simple workflow automation	Quick integrations, less technical clients

AI/Chatbot Builders

Tool	Purpose
Voiceflow	AI chatbot and voice assistant builder
Botpress	Open-source chatbot platform
Retell AI	AI voice agents

AI Models & APIs

Tool	Purpose
OpenAI (GPT-4, GPT-4o)	Primary LLM for most agency work
Anthropic (Claude)	Alternative LLM, strong for analysis/coding
Google (Gemini)	Multi-modal AI capabilities
DeepSeek	Cost-effective LLM alternative
ElevenLabs	AI voice generation

Data & Infrastructure

Tool	Purpose
Pinecone	Vector database for AI/RAG applications
Supabase	Open-source backend/database
LangChain	LLM application framework
Microsoft Autogen	Multi-agent AI framework

Content & Media

Tool	Purpose
Pictory	AI video editing
Fliki AI	Voiceovers and video creation
InVideo AI	End-to-end video generation

Business Operations

Tool	Purpose
Skool	Community management and course hosting
Framer	Agency website builder
Bubble	No-code SaaS builder

Recommended Starting Stack (New Agency)

1. **Make.com** -- primary automation platform for client work
2. **Voiceflow** -- chatbot/voice agent builds
3. **n8n** -- self-hosted solutions for enterprise clients or internal use
4. **OpenAI API** -- core AI capabilities
5. **Supabase or Pinecone** -- data storage for RAG applications

Key Takeaways & Strategic Insights

1. **The audit is the entry point.** A \$500-\$15,000 audit naturally leads to \$10K-\$50K+ implementation projects. "Once you've done the diagnosis, you become the obvious person to build the solution."
2. **Niche down.** The most successful agencies specialize in one industry. Med spas, SaaS companies, healthcare, and financial services are particularly lucrative.
3. **Sell outcomes, not technology.** Clients care about cost savings, revenue growth, and efficiency -- not the complexity of your AI models.
4. **The hybrid pricing model wins.** Start with project-based for cash flow, transition to retainers for recurring revenue, add usage-based fees for scaling.
5. **The market is maturing.** By 2026, the industry is moving from "sell automation" to "sell outcomes." Agencies that offer consulting + education + software development will outcompete pure-play automation shops.
6. **Mid-market is the sweet spot.** Companies with \$5M-\$100M revenue are big enough to afford AI services but small enough to lack in-house AI teams.
7. **Tools are commoditizing.** The execution cost of AI is dropping ~40x per year. The real value is in business analysis, strategy, and change management -- not just building the automation.

8. **Realistic expectations:** The "\$10K in 90 days" claim is marketing. A more realistic timeline is 6-12 months of intensive work to build a sustainable agency.

Sources

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 - [Comprehensive Call Process Audit Checklist](#)
 - [How to Start an AI Agency \(Voiceflow\)](#)
 - [PwC: End-to-End AI Audit Automation \(2026\)](#)
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